HIGH CARD BATTLE

PREPARE THE CARDS

For 2–10 players. Each player takes all 18 cards from one army and its patron, shuffles them together, and places the deck face down. Set ATTACK and SUPPORT cards aside.

REVEAL AND COMPARE

Everyone reveals the top card at the same time. A patron beats any number; otherwise, the highest number wins. The winner takes all cards revealed in this battle.

WHEN THE HIGHEST CARD IS TIED

Only the players tied for the highest card continue the showdown: each reveals another card. The others wait. If the highest value is tied again, only those players continue. If only one tied player can continue, they win and take all cards on the table. If none can continue, the cards on the table do not count.

THREE-PLAYER EXAMPLE

8 = 8 > 5 → 3 < 6

The players with an 8 reveal another card; the player with a 5 waits. The player with a 6 wins and takes all five cards on the table: the original 5, both 8s, and the 3 and 6. The player with the 5 does not use an extra card; if one remains in their deck at the end, they count it.

END OF GAME

The game ends when fewer than two players can reveal a card against each other, or when all tied players run out of cards in a showdown. Cards from an unresolved showdown do not count. Each player counts the cards they have won plus any cards left in their deck. The highest total wins; equal totals are a draw.

VM FANTASY BATTLE

Two army games

Battle 2–4 · High Card Battle 2–10 · Ages 6–9

Number comparison, addition and subtraction

OBJECTIVE OF THE BATTLE

Your cards show the number of units in your army. ATTACK cards reduce an opponent’s units; SUPPORT cards increase your own. After each change, calculate the new total and rebuild your army with cards. Be the first to reduce an opponent’s army to 0.

ATTACK EXAMPLE

10 − 3 = 7

CHOOSE A LEVEL

Beginner	10	−1 to −3	+1 to +3
Adventurer	15	−1 to −5	+1 to +5
Hero	20	−1 to −6	+1 to +5

Choose the highest totals that all players can calculate.

GETTING STARTED

1 PREPARE YOUR ARMIES

Each player chooses a different army, such as Knights, Zombies, Orcs, or Goblins. Take 18 unit cards from your army and your +5 patron. Build a starting army of 10, 15, or 20 units, depending on the level. Use one or more cards, for example 10 = 4 + 3 + 3. Keep the remaining cards nearby as your reserve, with your patron face up.

ATTACK and SUPPORT cards are shared by all armies. For 2 players, use 18 ATTACK cards and 9 SUPPORT cards; for 3–4 players, use 36 ATTACK cards and 18 SUPPORT cards. Shuffle the two decks separately. For Beginner, remove ATTACK −4 to −6 and SUPPORT +4 and +5; for Adventurer, remove ATTACK −6. The youngest player starts.

2 TAKE ONE ACTION EACH TURN

ATTACK Choose an opponent, reveal the top ATTACK card, and calculate their new unit total. The opponent rebuilds their army. Discard the ATTACK card.

SUPPORT Reveal the top SUPPORT card. Add its value to your army and rebuild it. Discard the card.

PATRON Once per game, instead of drawing a card, add +5 to your army. Rebuild it and turn your patron face down.

Then play passes to the next player. Each turn has one action.

AGREED UNIT LIMIT

Agree on the highest total everyone can handle (for example, 10), or play without a limit. Calculate SUPPORT cards that would exceed the limit and discard them without changing your army. Use your patron only when its +5 fits under the limit.

BATTLE SEQUENCE

3 CALCULATE AND REBUILD

After any change, use any of your unit cards from the table and your reserve to show the new total exactly. Return unused cards to your reserve; they are never permanently discarded. Other players may check the total.

EXAMPLE TURNS

Attack. Goblins have 10 = 6 + 4. A Knight reveals ATTACK −3 and says 10 − 3 = 7. The Goblin player lays out, for example, 5 + 2 = 7.

Support. Orcs have 5 = 3 + 2. They reveal SUPPORT +2, calculate 5 + 2 = 7, and rebuild their army, for example with 4 + 3.

Patron. Your patron increases your total from 4 to 9: 4 + 5 = 9. Rebuild your army and turn your patron face down.

PLAYING WITH 2, 3 OR 4 PLAYERS

2: Play against each other. 3: Everyone plays individually; the attacker chooses one opponent. 4: Form two teams and take turns A–B–A–B. You may attack only the other team. SUPPORT and patron cards help only your own army.

4 ENDING THE BATTLE

When an opponent’s army reaches 0 after an attack, remove all their unit cards; they are eliminated and skip future turns. They can no longer use their patron. With 2–3 players, the last army wins. With 4 players, the team with at least one army remaining wins. An attack greater than the number of units reduces it to 0: 2 − 3 → 0.

When SUPPORT cards run out, do not return them. When ATTACK cards run out, shuffle the discarded ATTACK cards and continue.

BATTLE LOG

Write changes to your army under MY ARMY; record your attacks under ENEMY ARMY with the target’s initial, for example O: 10 − 2 = 8 for Orcs.